

Chapter 174

ADR (Automated Dialog Replacement)

The Fairlight page of DaVinci Resolve has a sophisticated interface for doing ADR, or automated dialog replacement, in a structured and straightforward manner.

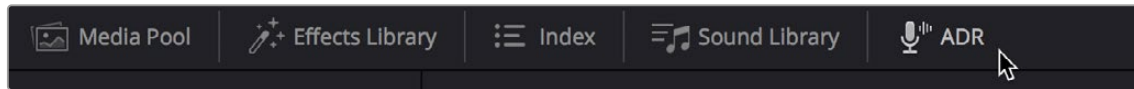
Simple, yet powerful, the ADR panel incorporates Cue list management, industry-standard audio beeps and visual cues, and sophisticated take management with star ratings and layered take organization to create and manage the re-recording of dialog in any program. With this sophisticated organization and layering, it's easy to edit together the best parts of each take into your program.

Contents

ADR (Automated Dialog Replacement).....	3763
The ADR Interface	3763
Setting up to Do an ADR Session	3767
Creating and Importing ADR Cue Lists.....	3768
AI Create ADR Cues (Studio Version Only).....	3768
Manually Creating an ADR Cue List.....	3769
Importing Cues.....	3770
Recording ADR to the Timeline.....	3771

ADR (Automated Dialog Replacement)

Clicking the ADR button on the Interface toolbar opens the Fairlight ADR panel, which offers a thoroughly professional automated dialog replacement workflow. Dialog replacement, for those who don't know, is the process whereby audio professionals bring in actors to re-record unusable dialog recordings from the comfort of their recording studios, line by line and with a great deal of patience.



The ADR panel on the Fairlight page

The Fairlight page aims to help you make this a structured and straightforward process. Simple, but powerful, Cue list management lets you efficiently assemble a re-recording plan.

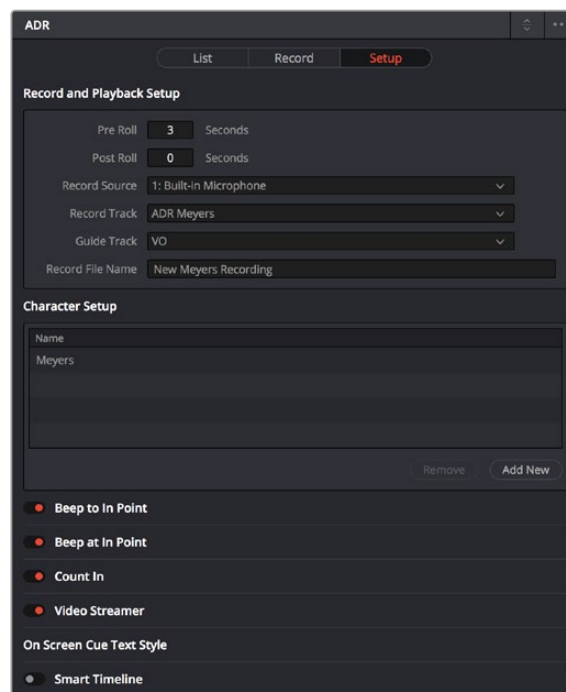
Industry-standard audio beeps and visual cues via your BMD video output device help the actors in the booth nail their timings and their lines. Then, sophisticated take management with star ratings and layered take organization in the Timeline help you manage the resulting recordings to pick and choose the best parts of each take when you edit the results.

The ADR Interface

The ADR interface consists of three panels to the left of the Timeline: a List panel, a Record panel, and a Setup panel. The controls of these panels are described in the order in which they're used..

The Setup Panel

As its name implies, the Setup panel is where you configure your ADR session.



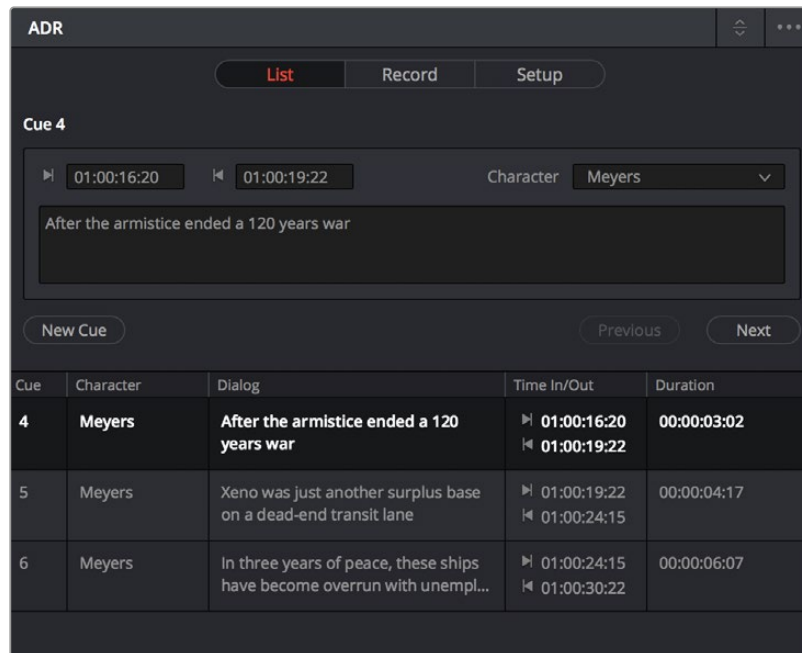
The Setup panel of the ADR interface

This panel presents the following controls:

- **Pre Roll and Post Roll:** Specifies how many seconds to play before and after each cue's specified In and Out points, giving actors a chance to listen to what comes before and after each cue in order to prepare. If you enable the Beep options below, they'll provide a countdown during the specified pre-roll.
- **Record Source:** This dropdown menu lets you choose the audio input you want to record from, creating a patch to the Record Track. However, this menu is disabled until you select a track in the Record Track dropdown menu.
- **Record Track:** This menu lets you choose the track you want to record on. Making this selection creates a patch from the Record Source to the Record Track and automatically toggles Record Enable on.
- **Guide Track:** This dropdown lets you choose the track containing the production audio you want to re-record. The talent will use the audio playback from this track as a guide when recording their replacement performance.
- **Record File Name:** This text field lets you enter a filename for the recorded audio.
- **Character Setup:** This is where you can add the character names you'll be re-recording, which helps with cue creation and management. Click the Add button to enter a new character name. To delete a character from the list, click the character name and then the Remove button.
- **Beep to In Point:** Enables a three-beep sequence, which the talent hears leading up to the recording. For the beeps to be audible, the Beeps channel of the System Generator must be patched to your audio outputs by going to Fairlight > Patch Input/Output.
- **Beep at In Point:** Enables one last beep at the In point. For the beep to be audible, the Beeps channel of the System Generator must be patched to your audio outputs by going to Fairlight > Patch Input/Output.
- **Count In:** Provides an onscreen counter that counts down to the start of the cue.
- **Video Streamer:** A visual cue for the talent to watch during pre-roll to ready them for recording. A pair of vertical lines superimposed over the program being output to video move towards one another across your video output screen during the pre-roll to the cue. This gives the talent a visual indication of the time remaining until they should begin talking. When the beeps play, these lines get taller. Both lines come together at the Time In frame, at which point a cross shows that recording is beginning.
- **On Screen Cue Text Style:** Clicking this heading reveals a set of parameters for configuring the look and placement of onscreen text cues.
- **Smart Timeline:** When turned on, this option automatically moves the playhead to each cue as it's selected in the Cue list, and zooms in to frame the duration of that cue in the Timeline.
- **Mixing Control:** Enables automated switching of audio playback, to independently control what the talent and the audio engineer hear at various stages of the ADR recording process. For example, with this enabled, the Guide track is not routed to the Control room while the engineer is reviewing a take.

The List Panel

This is where you create a list of cues you need to re-record, either from within the Fairlight page or imported from a .csv file.



The List panel of the ADR interface

This panel includes the following controls:

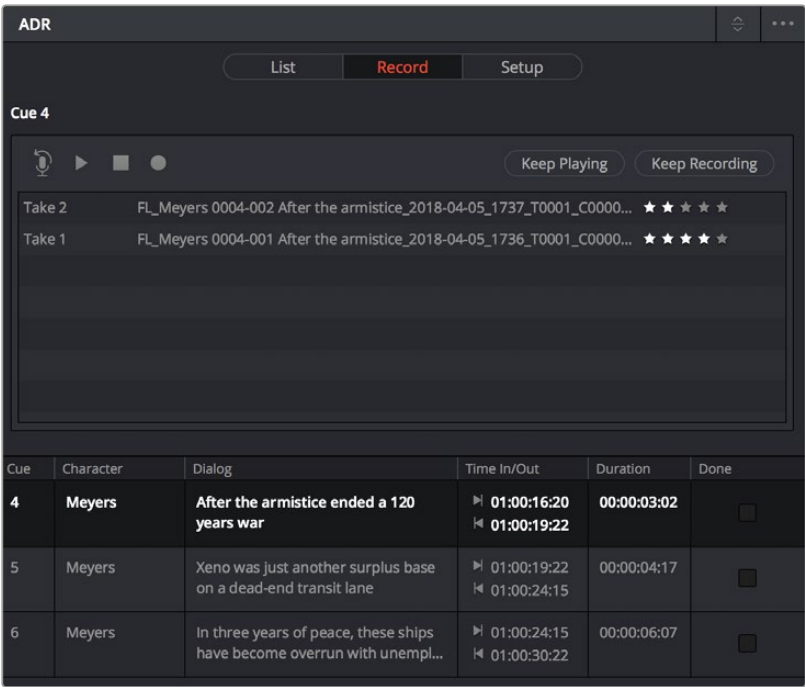
- **Cue editing controls:** Displays the data for the currently selected cue (or a cue that was just created). In and Out timecode fields store the Timeline In and Out points that were set when the cue was created but can be manually edited for fine tuning. A Character dropdown menu lets you choose which character that line of dialog belongs to. A text entry field lets you enter the dialog cue that's to be re-recorded, so you and the talent can both refer to it.
- **New Cue button:** Clicking this button adds a new cue to the list using whatever In and Out points have been set in the Timeline, and whatever character was last selected.
- **Cue list:** The list of all cues that have been entered or imported. The Cue list can be filtered using the Filter dropdown menu at the top-right of the ADR panel (next to the option menu). You can choose to show the cues for all characters, or for any selected combination of characters. You can also choose to hide all cues that are marked as done to experience the joy of this list shrinking more and more the closer you are to being finished.

Additionally, the ADR interface option menu has three commands pertaining to the List panel:

- **Import Cue List:** Lets you import a properly formatted .csv file to create cues that have been prepared in a spreadsheet. Correct formatting for cue lists you want to import is no headers, one line per cue, with four individual columns for In timecode, Out timecode, Character Name, and Dialog.
- **Export Cue List:** Lets you export the contents of the Cue list to a .csv file, for exchange or safe-keeping.
- **Clear Cue List:** Deletes all cues in the Cue list. It's recommended you export a copy of your Cue list before eliminating it completely, in case you ever need to revisit a cue.

The Record Panel

This is where you actually run the ADR recording session you've set up, using the dialog cues you've put into the Cue list.



The Record panel of the ADR Interface

This panel presents the following controls:

- **Record and rehearse controls:** Four transport controls and two buttons let you control recording during ADR sessions. These controls are only clickable when you've selected a cue from the Cue list to record.

Rehearse: Runs the section of the Timeline specified by a cue without actually recording anything, giving the talent an opportunity to run through their dialog and practice their timing and delivery. Beeps and on-screen streamers are not played during a rehearsal.

Play: Plays the currently selected take from the Take list (described below). If no take is selected, the most recently recorded one on top is played.

Stop: Immediately stops rehearsal, playback, or recording.

Record: Initiates recording of the cue to the specified audio track, with cue beeps and video streamer cues.

Keep Playing: At the end of a take you may wish to keep playing, so the talent can hear the next section of the track. Pressing the Keep Playing button at any time, even while recording, results in post roll being ignored and normal playback resuming after the cue's Out time.

Keep Recording: At the end of a take you may wish to keep recording until you manually stop. Pressing the Keep Recording button at any time, even while recording, results in the Out point of the current cue being ignored and recording continuing until you stop it.

- **Take list:** The Take list shows every take you've recorded for the current cue, with take number, name, and a five-star rating that you can set to keep track of which takes worked and which didn't. Earlier takes are at the bottom of this list, while recent takes are at the top (the same order in which the corresponding layered audio clips appear in the Timeline track they've been recorded to).

- **Cue list:** The list of all cues that have been entered or imported. The Cue list can be filtered using the Filter dropdown menu at the top-right of the ADR panel (next to the Option menu). You can choose to show the cues for all characters, or for any selected combination of characters. You can also choose to hide all cues that are marked as done to experience the joy of this list shrinking more and more the closer you are to being finished.
- **Cue list Done column:** A sixth column appears in the Record panel only, labeled Done. It contains check boxes for each cue that you can turn on to keep track of which cues you've successfully finished.

Additionally, the ADR interface Option menu has one command pertaining to the Record panel:

- **Record Early In:** Enables recording during pre-roll, in the event you're working with talent that likes to start early.

Setting up to Do an ADR Session

Setting up to record ADR is straightforward but requires a few steps.

Creating tracks in preparation to record ADR:

- 1 In the Timeline, create a new audio track to which you'll be doing ADR recording. Make sure it has the correct channel configuration for your recording (mono is typical for dialog).
- 2 If you're recording ADR to your main timeline, you may want to Solo both the Guide track and the Record track, so you and the talent can focus on the audio being re-recorded without hearing all the other tracks of the current mix.

Now you're ready to configure the Setup panel.

Configuring the Setup panel:

- 1 Open the ADR interface, and then open the Setup panel.
- 2 Choose the Pre Roll and Post Roll you want to use, in seconds. A pre roll of at least 3 seconds is recommended to give the talent time to get ready.
- 3 From the Record Source dropdown menu, choose the microphone you patched earlier.
- 4 From the Record Track dropdown menu, choose the Record track you created.
- 5 From the Guide Track dropdown menu, choose the track with the original production audio that you're replacing.
- 6 At the bottom of this panel, turn on which Preroll Cue options you and the talent want to use as you record each cue. Options include:
 - a) Beep to In Point and Beep at In Point provide an audible count down to when to start performing.
 - b) An animated Video Streamer gives a countdown to the start time, shows the duration of the cue being recorded, and also displays the text of the dialog for that cue on screen for the actor to refer to, so they can keep their eyes on the screen and not a script.

Next, if you've enabled Beep to In Point and Beep at In Point, you need to patch the Fairlight oscillator to your output channels so the talent can hear the preview beeps.

Patching the Oscillator to play beeps over your audio output:

- 1 Choose Fairlight > Patch Input/Output to open the Patch Input/Output window.
- 2 Choose System Generator from the Source dropdown menu, and click to select Beeps.
- 3 Choose Audio Outputs from the Destination dropdown, and choose the left/right outputs you want these preview beeps to play out of. You can drag a bounding box to select multiple outputs, thereby connecting the mono Beeps input to stereo output for comfortable listening.
- 4 Click Patch to make the connection, then close the Patch Input/Output window.

Creating and Importing ADR Cue Lists

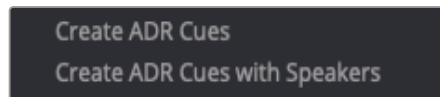
You must have a list of cues to be able to use the ADR interface properly. There are two ways you can create a Cue list to record with, make one from scratch on the Fairlight page, or import one. The ADR panel accommodates both workflows.

AI Create ADR Cues (Studio Version Only)

AI Create ADR Cues is part of DaVinci Resolve's Intellicut feature set, which also includes two other features: Remove Silence and AI Checkerboard to New Tracks.

For more information about Remove Silence and AI Checkerboard to New Tracks, see *Chapter 175, "Editing Basics in the Fairlight Page."*

It's an old joke that ADR isn't really automatic. However, this feature analyzes and transcribes a selection of timeline clips on a track, then automatically generates individual ADR cues, with two output options explained below.



Timeline clip contextual menu for creating ADR cues

NOTE: The dialogue must be spoken in one of the supported languages listed in the Project Settings under Subtitles and Transcriptions > Language.

For more information about the Subtitles and Transcription settings, see *Chapter 6, "Project Settings."*

ADR cues will be generated in the language selected in the Project Settings under Subtitles and Transcriptions. The default selection is "Auto," which applies the language setting of your computer's operating system to all projects. However if, for example, you manually select English as the project language and then create ADR cues for dialog spoken in French, the resulting cues will be written in English.

Create ADR Cues

Right-clicking a selection of timeline clips on a track and choosing AI Tools > Create ADR Cues from the contextual menu opens the Transcribing Audio dialog, showing the progress of the analysis and transcription. Once the dialog closes, the transcribed cues are added to the List page in the ADR panel, along with their Cue ID, Time In/Out, and Durations.

Cue ID	Character	Dialog	Time In/Out	Duration
1		This is a half-calf double-talk, two shots sugar-free vanilla mocha latte. With whip! Here, go pass these out.	▶ 01:00:00:22 ◀ 01:00:08:16	00:00:07:18
2		Who are you?	▶ 01:00:09:20 ◀ 01:00:11:04	00:00:01:07
3		I'm new, but I'd follow you.	▶ 01:00:11:01 ◀ 01:00:13:04	00:00:02:02

New ADR cues

Create ADR Cues with Speakers

Right-clicking the timeline clip selection and selecting AI Tools > Create ADR Cues with Speakers from the contextual menu adds the transcribed cues to the List page, as described above, along with each Speaker's name in the Character column.

Cue ID	Character	Dialog	Time In/Out	Duration
1	Speaker 1	This is a half-calf double-talk, two shots sugar-free vanilla mocha latte. With whip! Here, go pass these out.	▶ 01:00:00:22 ◀ 01:00:08:16	00:00:07:18
2	Speaker 1	Who are you?	▶ 01:00:09:20 ◀ 01:00:11:04	00:00:01:07
3	Speaker 2	I'm new, but I'd follow you.	▶ 01:00:11:01 ◀ 01:00:13:04	00:00:02:02

New ADR cues with speaker names added to the Character column

Manually Creating an ADR Cue List

If you've been doing all of your dialog editing inside of DaVinci Resolve, you can go ahead and create a list by marking the sections of the Timeline you need to re-record and creating cues from those timings. To create cues properly, you should start by adding the names of each character you'll be creating a cue for in the Setup panel. These names make it easier to enter cues and will help you to filter and sort the list as necessary later on.

To add character names before entering cues:

- 1 Open the Setup panel of the ADR interface.
- 2 Click Add New.
- 3 When a selected entry appears in the Character Setup list, type a name.
- 4 Press Return when you're done.

To edit the Character Setup list, do one of the following:

- If you mis-spell a name, you can double-click any name in this list to edit it.
- To delete a name, you can select it and click Remove to eliminate it.

Once you've created a complete set of character names, you can begin creating your Cue list.

To manually add cues to the Cue list:

- 1 Open the List panel of the ADR interface. This is where all the controls for creating and editing cues are.
- 2 In the Timeline, set In and Out points to mark the section of dialog you want to turn into a cue. Those timecode values appear in the Cue Editing section of the List panel.
- 3 Click New Cue to add a blank cue to the Cue list.
- 4 In the Cue Editing section, choose the character who's speaking that cue from the Character dropdown (only names that have been entered in the Setup tab appear in this list).
- 5 If necessary, select the text field below, and type the dialog that needs to be re-recorded.
- 6 Repeat steps 2 through 5 until you're finished creating all the cues you intend to re-record. If you need to edit any cue, simply click to select that cue, and edit it in the Cue Editing section above.

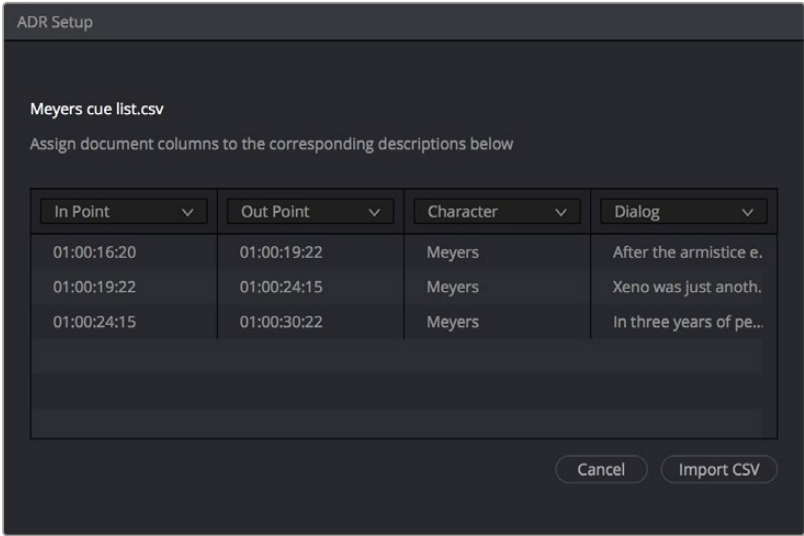
Importing Cues

If you or an assistant has already created a Cue list using a spreadsheet with separate columns for character names, dialog, and In/Out timecode values, then you can also create a Cue list by importing this data from an exported .csv file.

To import a .csv file to the Cue list:

- 1 Choose Import Cue List from the ADR option menu, then use the dialog to choose the .csv file containing the Cue list you were given, and click Open.
- 2 An ADR Setup dialog appears, showing the data from the .csv file previewed as a series of columns. This lets you see if each column of incoming data is being assigned correctly. If it's not, you can reassign each column of the incoming data to the correct column of the ADR panel.

Correct formatting for Cue lists you want to import is to have no header text, and to enter information using one row per cue, with four individual columns for In timecode, Out timecode, Character Name, and Dialog. If any of these columns are transposed, you can correct this by choosing the correct data type for each column from the dropdown menus at top.



Dialog for rearranging columns of cue data, if necessary

- 3 Click Import CSV. The cues should appear in the Cue list.

To export a .csv file from the Cue list:

- Choose Export Cue List from the ADR option menu, choose a location to save the file, and click Save.

Recording ADR to the Timeline

Once you've configured your workstation for recording, and you've set up a Cue list to work with, it's time to start recording each cue.

To record a cue from the Cue list:

- 1 Open the Record panel of the ADR interface.
- 2 If you want to record a particular character's cues, you can select each unnecessary character in the ADR Option menu to uncheck that character, hiding their dialog in the Cue list.
- 3 With the list showing the character cues you need, select the cue you want to start recording. That cue contains the timecode necessary to determine which part of the Timeline to record to, and the playhead automatically moves to that part of the Timeline.
- 4 Click the Rehearse button a few times to run through the cue with the talent. When you click Rehearse, both audio and video corresponding to that cue will play, including pre roll and post roll, along with all beep and onscreen cues.
- 5 When the talent is ready to try a take, click the Record button, and let the Fairlight page do the work of playing through pre roll with beep notifications and visual streamer cues, initiating recording, and then stopping recording automatically once the cue is done. To record another take, simply click the Record button again.

Every time you complete a recording, a take appears in the Take list. Making multiple recordings results in multiple takes in the list. In the Timeline, all new takes appear as layered audio, so you can record as many takes as you like into the same area of the Timeline. Once you've finished recording takes, you'll have a neatly organized stack of alternate takes to draw upon as you edit together the best parts of each recording.

- 6 If you or the talent want to hear a particular take again, select it in the Take list and click Play. You can use the 5-star ratings control to keep track of how you liked each take.
- 7 When you're finished recording a cue, click the Done checkbox for that cue, and select the next cue you want to record. When you're finished re-recording dialog, simply close the ADR interface.